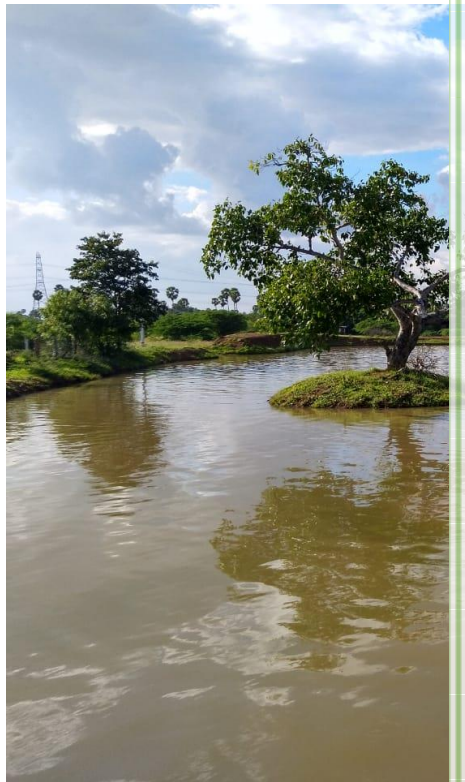


COODU TRUST
Annual Report
2019-20



Submitted by



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WATERSHED

A watershed, also called a drainage basin or catchment area, is defined as an area in which all water flowing into it goes to a common outlet. People and livestock are the integral part of watershed and their activities affect the productive status of watersheds and vice versa. From the hydrological point of view, the different phases of hydrological cycle in a watershed are dependent on the various natural features and human activities. Watershed is not simply the hydrological unit but also sociopolitical-ecological entity which plays crucial role in determining food, social, and economical security and provides life support services to rural people.

IWMP

Coodu Trust implemented the Integrated Watershed Development Project through the District Watershed Development Agency [DWDA] in various districts across Tamil Nadu.

Objectives

The main objectives of the IWMP are to restore the ecological balance by harnessing, conserving and developing degraded natural resources such as soil, water and vegetative cover. The outcomes are prevention of soil run-off, regeneration of natural vegetation, rainwater harvesting and recharging of the ground water table. This enables multi-cropping and the introduction of diverse agro-based activities, which help to provide sustainable livelihoods to the people residing in the watershed area. In addition, there is a Scheme of Technology Development Extension and Training (TDET) is also being implemented to promote development of cost effective and proven technologies to support watershed management.

The objectives of a Watershed include, effectively conserve soil, rainwater and vegetation and harvest the surplus water in addition to ground water recharge. They also promote sustainable farming and stabilize crop yields by adopting suitable cropping and crop management systems. It also covers non-arable area effectively through afforestation, horticulture and pasture development based on land capability. Finally watersheds enhance the income of the individuals by adopting alternative enterprises and restore the ecological balance.

The key activities undertaken under the watershed program included Entry Point Activities that were knowledge-based to build the rapport with the community. It also included soil and water conservation practices primarily 1) in-situ and 2) ex-situ management. These practices protect land degradation, improve soil health, and increase soil-moisture availability and groundwater recharge. Moreover, construction of check dam, farm pond, gully control structures, pits excavation across the stream channel are known as ex-situ management. Ex-situ watershed management practices reduce peak discharge in order to reclaim gully formation and harvest substantial amount of runoff, which increases groundwater recharge and irrigation potential in watersheds.

MKSP

Coodu Trust implemented the MKSP project in Karur district of Tamil Nadu through the major interventions being - Orientation and Training to staff of MKSP, Training to Community Resource Person [CRP] (KishiSakhi), Training to CRP (PasuSakhi), Exposure visit to CRPs on immersion sites, engaging in IEC activities related to the project through Wall writings / Public information disclosure and Training Module Development in printed booklets and audio-visuals documentation. The scope of the project also included Training and exposure visit for the Mahila Kisans, organizing Farm Field Schools, conducting Veterinary camps and establishment of Custom Hiring Centres

The MKSP Project intervened with 5,000 farmers in the Blocks of Kadavur and Thanthoni and sought to achieve enhanced family incomes by Rs.10,000 - 15,000/- for 60% of participating women (including money value of enhanced food sufficiency) through realizing the following objectives:

- Create sustainable agriculture and animal husbandry; livelihood opportunities for women Kisans.
- Improve the skills and capabilities of women in agriculture to support farm and livelihood based activities;
- Ensure food and nutrition security at the household and the community level.
- Enable women to have better access to inputs and services of the government and other agencies;
- Improve the capacities of women in agriculture to access the resources of other institutions and schemes within a convergence framework.
- Crop intensification of paddy, maize, wheat and gram and diversification into pulses and commercial vegetable farming.
- Protective irrigation from harvested rainwater.
- Enhanced production of cereals by 100 % with the intervened families.
- Multi-cropping including long-tenure plantations of fruits trees and timber plants as Agro horticulture and Agro Forestry.
- Enhance the productive participation of women in agriculture and animal husbandry.

Coverage

The IWMP coverage area included 1,240 beneficiaries from Pudukkottai, 980 beneficiaries in Thoothukudi, 700 beneficiaries in Salem and 480 beneficiaries in Tiruvanamalai districts.

Further, under the TATA Power water security project, a total of over 500 Ha was covered. Similarly, through the United Way CSR Project through ATG Tires, more than 1500 Ha of land was covered through the watershed project in Manur Block of Tirunelveli district.

Under the MKSP project, 5000 Mahila Kisans were empowered by enhancing socio economic conditions through entrepreneurship development by developing agriculture based trades in Kadavur and Thanthoni Blocks of Karur district.

SKILL DEVELOPMENT

Skill development has emerged as a key strategy to realize the potential of demographic advantage of having the youngest workforce with an average age of 29 years in comparison with the advanced economies to create human resource for improving country's competitiveness and growth. Growth focuses on providing skilling support in line with industry requirements as well as the individual's aspirations.

Objectives

Supported by a committed team of certified trainers, the emphasis is on enhancing core employment skills by focusing on learning outcomes via measuring the skill shift through pre and post assessments. The effort is aided by the grow it platform that maps the entire life cycle of youth and the matchmaking engine helps in placing youth as per their aspirations and competencies.

National Rurban Mission (NRuM)

National Rurban Mission (NRuM) was launched by Government of India in 2015 aiming at developing cluster of villages with facilities perceived to be essentially urban in nature, thus creating of “Rurban villages”. The objective of the National Rurban Mission (NRuM) is to stimulate local economic development, enhance basic services and create well planned Rurban clusters.

The following components are envisaged as desirable components in each cluster: (i) Skill development training linked to economic activities (ii) Agro Processing, Agri Services, Storage and Warehousing. (iii) Fully equipped mobile health unit, (iv) Upgrade school/higher education facilities. (v) Sanitation (vi) Provision of piped water supply. (vii) Solid and liquid waste management. (viii) Village streets and drains. (ix) Street lights (x) Inter-village road connectivity. (xi) Public transport. (xii) LPG gas connections (xiii) Digital Literacy. (xiv) Citizen Service Centres- for electronic delivery of citizen centric services/e-gram connectivity.

Tamil Nadu Skill Development Corporation [TNSDC]

Tamil Nadu Skill Development Corporation was formed with a vision to transform the state into skill hub by skilling the youth to enhance their employability and match the expectations of the Industry.

TNSDC is the nodal agency for skill related training and aims to catalyze the skill development eco-system in the State. It actively collaborates with Government Agencies, reputed private skill training institutions and industry partners to impart industry oriented and placement linked skill training.

Coodu Trust was appointed as a Training Partner with registered Training Centres on TNSDC portal and acted as an umbrella organization for its respective Training Centres. It conducted training under various NSQF aligned job roles in accordance with the guidelines laid down by the TNSDC. These centres were established as per TNSDC norms. Assessment is one of the most important activities of the skills value chain. Trainees were assessed & certified by State Council for Vocational Training (SCVT)/ Sector Skill Council (SSC), and the major trades in which training was conducted included Agriculture – Dairy Farmer/ Entrepreneur, Information Technology, Garment Making, Medical & Nursing, Automotive Repair, Refrigeration & Air Conditioning, Beauty Culture & Hair Dressing, Light Engineering & Automobiles.

Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana-National Urban Livelihoods Mission (DAY-NULM)

The core belief of National Urban Livelihoods Mission (NULM) is that the poor are entrepreneurial and have innate desire to come out of poverty. The challenge is to unleash their capabilities to generate meaningful and sustainable livelihoods. The first step in this process is motivating the urban poor to form their own institutions. They and their institutions need to be providing sufficient capacity so that they can manage the external environment, access finance, expand their skills, enterprises and assets. This requires continuous and

carefully designed handholding support. An external, dedicated and sensitive support structure, from the national level to the city community levels, is required to induce social mobilization, institution building and livelihood promotion.

NULM believes that any livelihood promotion programme can be scaled up in a time bound manner only if driven by the poor and their institutions. Such strong institutional platforms support the poor in building up their own human, social, financial, and other assets. This in turn, enables them access to right, entitlements, opportunities and services from the public and private sectors, while enhancing their solidarity, voice and bargaining power.

WOMEN EMPOWERMENT

The empowerment and autonomy of women and the improvement of their political, social, economic and health status is a highly important end in itself. In addition, it is essential for the achievement of sustainable development. The full participation and partnership of both women and men is required in productive and reproductive life, including shared responsibilities for the care and nurturing of children and maintenance of the household. In all parts of the world, women are facing threats to their lives, health and well-being as a result of being overburdened with work and of their lack of power and influence. In most regions of the world, women receive less formal education than men, and at the same time, women's own knowledge, abilities and coping mechanisms often go unrecognized. The power relations that impede women's attainment of healthy and fulfilling lives operate at many levels of society, from the most personal to the highly public. Achieving change requires policy and programme actions that will improve women's access to secure livelihoods and economic resources, alleviate their extreme responsibilities with regard to housework, remove legal impediments to their participation in public life, and raise social awareness through effective programmes of education and mass communication. Experience shows that population and development programmes are most effective when steps have simultaneously been taken to improve the status of women.

Formation of women's self-help groups (WSHGs) is a well-established strategy in India for empowering women and improving their livelihoods. The Directorate of Mission Shakti in Odisha has taken significant measures to support close to 7 lakh WSHGs in the state, by enabling them to access financial assistance, undertake capacity strengthening and market linkage to enhance their livelihoods and incomes. Economic activities through WSHGs significantly supplement incomes of women smallholder farmers, a critical vulnerable group, deprived of access to agricultural credit, inputs and markets, owing to gender-based discrimination. It is also true that income in the hands of women ensures food security and nutrition for the entire family. Therefore, empowering and equipping them with better incomes will bring greater benefits to community food and nutrition security.

The key learnings with respect to women empowerment done by Coodu Trust include:

1. **Collective action:** Long-term, quantifiable vision and Mission Shakti charter needs to be established, with clear alignment of structures, and stakeholder roles and responsibilities towards the common outcome.
2. **Remove systemic issues** and utilize data for decision making, including creation of an MIS and transparency portal and a complaints and feedback mechanism.
3. **Awareness and training** to be improved in content and periodicity.
4. **Build capacity** through peer learning from well-performing WSHGs, more intensive training on finance and accounts, training women as nutrition educators and expanded options for services such as transportation, sales and sourcing.

5. **Identify market demand** and conduct careful market planning with diversification of products to ensure adequate market space for all WSHGs.
6. **Empowerment:** Enhance female ownership and steering of processes, preventing domination of males as that could turn exploitative.

Key Learnings

The key learnings arrived at following Skill Development program implementation include Establishing Credibility & Trust, Nurturing Core Employability Skills, Placement & Entrepreneurship and the Importance of Monitoring.

Coverage

Under the NRuM program beneficiaries were covered in three districts namely Tirunelveli [2,220 beneficiaries], Tiruvallur [1,600 beneficiaries], and Sivagangai [1250 beneficiaries].

The number of beneficiaries under TNSDC included 120 from Karur district.

The NULM program witnessed coverage among 720 beneficiaries across the districts of Karur, Chennai, Salem, Theni, Trichy, Tirunelveli and Vellore.

Under the DDU-GKY [Grameen], 500 beneficiaries were covered across Karur and Dindigul districts.

DRINKING WATER

Safe and readily available water is important for public health, whether it is used for drinking, domestic use, food production or recreational purposes. Improved water supply and sanitation, and better management of water resources, can boost countries' economic growth and can contribute greatly to poverty reduction.

Sustainable Development Goal target 6.1 calls for universal and equitable access to safe and affordable drinking water. The target is tracked with the indicator of "safely managed drinking water services" – drinking water from an improved water source that is located on premises, available when needed, and free from faecal and priority chemical contamination.

Through the Supreme Industries CSR program, drinking water supply through RO was provided to 3 Primary Schools for around 375 children in Kadavur Block of Karur district.

TWAD Board

Water Quality Testing was undertaken with more than 12000 samples collected for TWAD Board across three districts of Tirunelveli, Dindigul and Sivagangai.

The Department of Environment & Forests Government of Tamil Nadu

Awareness on Plastics Utility and Environment Protection Strategies through Street Play and Exhibition was conducted among 30000 students / rural communities from rural schools of the selected blocks of Karur district and awareness was created on plastics utilisation and environment protection. The action component included awareness on ill-effects of plastics will be created to the school students through street plays and exhibitions.

The same was conducted across 8 districts in Tamil Nadu – Dindigul, Karur, Ramanathapuram, Sivagangai, Virudhunagar, Ariyalur, Perambalur and Thanjavur.